Garrett Summers
Bozeman, Montana

DATE October 27, 2026
RE Incident outside the Filling Station, Friday, October 23, 2026
911 CALL 26-158520
LATER CALLS 26-158660, 26-159664

An open letter on the incident outside the Filling Station

To the Bozeman community and the Bozeman Police Department,

On Friday, October 23, outside the Filling Station, I watched a group of men repeatedly throw snowballs at two women who had told them no. Other eyewitnesses told me the snowballs contained rocks. I confronted the men. They did not take responsibility; they ran. I called 911.

I am not affiliated with the venue. I was there promoting the opening band, which I had brought in from Boulder. I was hit too, but I was not the target, and I would not have called on my own behalf. I called because of what was being done to those two women.

According to the sergeant I spoke with, no crime was recorded because the women could not be located to give statements. Ride-share records could likely have identified them, but as I understand Montana law, the bar for obtaining those records is so high that in practice it is cleared mainly in domestic violence cases.

I find this deeply concerning.

Throwing snowballs is one thing. Throwing them at people who have said no, allegedly with rocks inside, is another. If the outcome of a case like this depends on whether the people targeted can be found, and the law keeps police from finding them, then, intentionally or not, our legal framework leaves people harmed by violence outside the home with less protection than they deserve. Privacy protections matter. So does a way to reach people who have been hurt.

I am not naming anyone, and I ask that no one else do so. I am not accusing the Filling Station, or the police, who as I understand it were limited by the law. I am asking:

— the Bozeman Police Department to confirm whether the reports of rocks were investigated;
— Montana's legislators to examine whether the standard for these records leaves victims of violence outside domestic cases without recourse.

Bozeman's live music scene should be a place where artists, audiences, and community members feel safe. That requires accountability, and a willingness to confront difficult situations even when doing so is uncomfortable.

Our community deserves the full story. I welcome factual corrections and firsthand accounts.

Sincerely,
Garrett Summers